



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2020-2021
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII

FULL MARKS: 40

SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)

TIME: 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES

General Instructions:

- This paper consists of three printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.

Question 1:

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- a) Your class was taken to visit an Old Age Home where you spent half a day with the residents. Write a letter to a friend telling him/her what you saw, how you felt and in what way you have changed since the visit.
- b) Write a letter to the Editor of a local newspaper complaining about the nuisance created by the rickshaw pullers and auto drivers near your school.

Question 2.

Your School is organizing a carnival to raise funds for the victims of Cyclone Amphan which struck Bengal recently. Write a notice for the school notice board informing the students about the event.

[5]

Question 3.

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

[10]

Isaac Newton, a name that may still be seen today cut into the wood of a window sill at King George's school where he studied Grammar and Latin. At first, Newton seemed to be a rather dull boy, and not very good at his lessons. But he used to use his hands and used to make little machines such as windmills. He caught mice and compelled them to drive some of his little machines.

One day at school, Newton was kicked by a bigger boy who was higher up in the class than he was. The kicking made Newton very angry and he turned on the bigger boy and gave him a good beating. He also decided to beat him at lessons, and this made him

start to work harder. After that, he improved at his studies, and so perhaps the big boy who kicked Newton did a service to the world.

Newton went to Cambridge University where he studied Mathematics and Science. He started to make discoveries while still at college. However, Newton did not confine his studies to Mathematics. He became interested in the behaviour of lights, and he showed that sunlight, which appears to be as white light, can be split up into the colours of the rainbow.

One day at school, Newton watched an apple as it fell from a tree. He wondered why it moved towards the earth and not towards the sky. After a great deal of thought on the subject, he produced the theory of gravitation and published it in his great book 'Principia'. He showed that every body attracts every other body. The sun and the earth attract each other and so we do not fly away from the sun into the darkness and the coldness of outer space; the moon and the earth also attract each other which is why the moon stays near us and does not rush away, leaving us in darkness every night.

Newton's head was usually so full of ideas and problems that he was often quite lost in thought. Many stories are told of his absent-mindedness. Once when he was entertaining some guests at dinner, he went out of the room to fetch some more wine. For a long time his guests awaited his return, but neither the host nor the wine appeared. At last they went to look for him, and found him hard at work in his study. The wine, the dinner and his guests were all forgotten.

On another occasion, Newton forgot all about the guest he had invited. After having waited for a long time, the guest could wait no longer. He sat down at the table and enjoyed a splendid dinner all alone after which he returned to the other chair and sat down once more to wait for his missing host.

a) Three words are given below. Give the meaning of each word as used in the passage.

One-word answers or short phrases will be accepted. [3]

- i) compelled
- ii) confine
- iii) splendid

b) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words:

- i) How did Newton spend his early days at school? [2]
- ii) Why is it said that the boy who kicked Newton did a service to the world? [2]
- iii) What other discovery did Newton make besides the theory of gravitation? [2]
- iv) Quote the line from the passage which illustrates Newton's theory of gravitation. [1]

Question 4.

Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using 'and', 'but' or 'so'. [4]

- a) The team entered the field. The crowd started cheering.
- b) The streets were flooded. Sara reached the station on time.
- c) Her grandfather gifted her a paint box. He knew she was good at art.
- d) Rina saw me at the restaurant. She came to join me.

Question 5.

Fill in each blank with the appropriate form of the word given in brackets: [4]

Mili __1__ (pour) milk into her cereal, when she _2__(hear) a _3__ (scratch) sound. She _4__(rush) to the door and __5__ (open) it. There _6__ (stand) a puppy __7__ (carry) an envelope in its mouth. Mili __8__ (pick) up the puppy.

Question 6.

Do as directed: [7]

Rewrite the following sentences correctly according to the instructions given after each. (Do not change the meaning of each sentence.)

- a) My grandmother says that honesty is the best policy. (Rewrite using direct speech)
- b) The editor has strongly criticized his opinions.(Change to passive voice)
- c) She has forgotten about our meeting. (completely) (Insert the adverb mentioned in bracket in the correct place)
- d) They are yet to _____ for the class as they are stuck in a traffic jam.(Complete the sentence with a suitable phrasal verb)
- e) Ravi and his family were_____ while they were returning from a late night party. (Rewrite using the correct phrasal verb)
- f) He walks his dog in the evenings. (rarely) (Insert the adverbs mentioned in brackets in the correct places)
- g) The cobbler's children have no shoes. (Identify the figure of Speech)